

fraud-investigating department to work with packaged-goods representatives to monitor coupon listings. And yet, to this day, with very little effort, I was able to unearth auction listings of “free product” coupons that are questionable, considering the same seller has listed and sold hundreds of similar sets.

For a long time I believed that people like Coupon Connie were an exception to the rule and the major players in coupon fraud were the fake storefronts, coupon brokers, and crooked businessmen. Certain that fraud and deception was only prevalent among the big-wigs of the coupon industry, I was blissfully unaware that, in 1983, Postal authorities had begun an investigation of refund conventions, code-named “Rebategate.”